

 Green Level: More Support

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Big Idea: Jazz was born in the early 1900s and became the soundtrack of the Harlem Renaissance. It mixed African musical traditions (call-and-response, rhythm, improvisation) with American instruments and city energy. Listening carefully to jazz can tell you a lot about how it works — and what it means.

PART 1: LISTENING RESPONSE**Listen to One Jazz Recording**

Your teacher will play a recording. As you listen, fill in this response:

Title / Artist: _____

1. List at least three instruments you can hear:

2. Circle the words that describe the mood of this music:

Joyful	Sad	Energetic	Peaceful	Powerful	Playful	Serious	Mysterious
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3. Does the music feel like it's talking to you — or like it's having a conversation with itself? Explain:

PART 2: CALL-AND-RESPONSE

Call-and-response is when one musical voice "calls" and another "answers." It comes from African music and American work songs.

4. Can you hear call-and-response in the recording? Which instruments are "calling" and "answering"?

5. Name one other place in your life where you hear call-and-response:

The Sound of Harlem

Grades 5–8 • Music • Green Level

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PART 3: THE 12-BAR BLUES

The Pattern Behind the Music

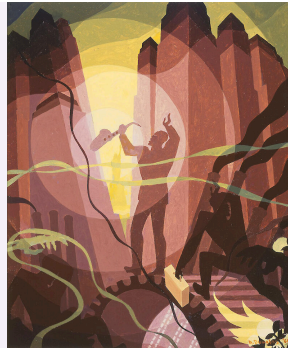
The 12-bar blues is a repeating 12-bar musical pattern. Almost every early jazz and blues song uses it. The pattern uses three chords (I, IV, V) — the Roman numerals just mean "first," "fourth," and "fifth" notes of the scale.

12-Bar Blues Pattern (key of C):

Bar 1 C (I)	Bar 2 C (I)	Bar 3 C (I)	Bar 4 C (I)
Bar 5 F (IV)	Bar 6 F (IV)	Bar 7 C (I)	Bar 8 C (I)
Bar 9 G (V)	Bar 10 F (IV)	Bar 11 C (I)	Bar 12 G (V)

6. Why do you think musicians liked this repeating pattern? What does it allow them to do?

7. Aaron Douglas painted the image below while listening to jazz in Harlem. What do you think he was seeing or feeling?



Aaron Douglas — *Song of the Towers*, 1934

Mini Museum Connection

The **Jazz Lab** in the exhibition lets you layer different jazz instruments to build a full band sound. Try removing one instrument at a time — which one changes the feel of the music most?

minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance